

WishTel to Launch Linux-Android Dual Boot Netbooks in India



Milind Shah, chief executive officer, WishTel

WishTel, a consumer electronics manufacturer from India, grabbed global headlines with just one smart move—the strategic launch of a Linux-based tablet PC called PrithV. With the product priced at Rs 3,300, WishTel not only won the hearts of those looking for affordable computing devices, but also made a name for itself in the open source community world wide. The tablet is priced only slightly higher than Aakash, the world's cheapest tablet PC. It sports a 17.7-cm (7-inch) LCD screen and comes with an 800 MHz processor. The tablet PC supports 85 languages in all, of which 23 are Indian. Apart from that, WishTel has a range of Android tablet PCs to offer, also at affordable price points. Wanting to know why the firm was banking so heavily on open source technology, **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You**, spoke with **Milind Shah**, chief executive officer, **WishTel**, who reveals all.

Q First of all, are all your products based on Android or Linux?

Yes. We do not use any platform other than open source technology to create our products. We have six products currently available in the market. Of these, three tablets are non-SIM based devices, while the remaining are SIM-based tablets. We are also set to launch a new range of netbooks, which will run Linux. The netbooks will also be offered in a varied price range. The low-end netbooks will come with the dual-boot option for Android and Linux, while the high-end products will come with either Linux or Android.

Q Was it just the fact that the tablet market is growing in India that drew you to this segment?

Yes, certainly. We identified the growth of the tablet

segment, particularly for Android tablets, much earlier. We saw that this space had enough potential for us to make an investment in and build a whole ecosystem.

Q Why did you choose Android and Linux as your preferred platform?

We as a company specialise in the thin-client and ARM-based ecosystem. Both Linux and Android are most suited for these platforms, and the platforms themselves are gaining momentum. The growth of Android as a tablet platform is yet another reason for us to venture into this segment. If you look at the growth graph of Android devices in the past one year, you will know why every OEM today wants to bring a good Android device into its portfolio.